

Neoclassicism in Britain, Germany and Russia

In newly industrialized Britain, architects such as John Nash (1752–1835) and John Wood the Younger (1728–82) reshaped London and Bath with neoclassical streets, crescents and parks. Sir John Soane (1753–1837) designed the Bank of England (1792); and Sir Robert Smirke (1780–1867) created the British Museum (begun 1823). Robert Adam (1728–92) designed country houses in his own detailed and unique interpretation of the classical style.

German neoclassicism was inspired by the writings of Johann Winckelmann (1717–68) and supported by Friedrich Wilhelm II of Prussia. It emerged through architects such as Karl Friedrich Schinkel (1781–1841), who designed Berlin's many-columned Altes Museum (1823–30), and Carl Gotthard Langhans (1732–1808), whose Brandenburg Gate (1793) was based on the Propylaea of the Acropolis. In Russia, meanwhile, Catherine the Great commissioned Charles Cameron (1745–1812) to design the Pavlovsk Palace (opposite, 1782–6), and Giacomo Quarenghi (1744–1817) to plan the Alexander Palace (1812).

